

Ideation Phase

Empathize & Discover

Date	18 July 2026
Team ID	SL-TEAM-01
Project Name	Smart Lender – AI Loan Approval System
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Empathy Map Canvas:

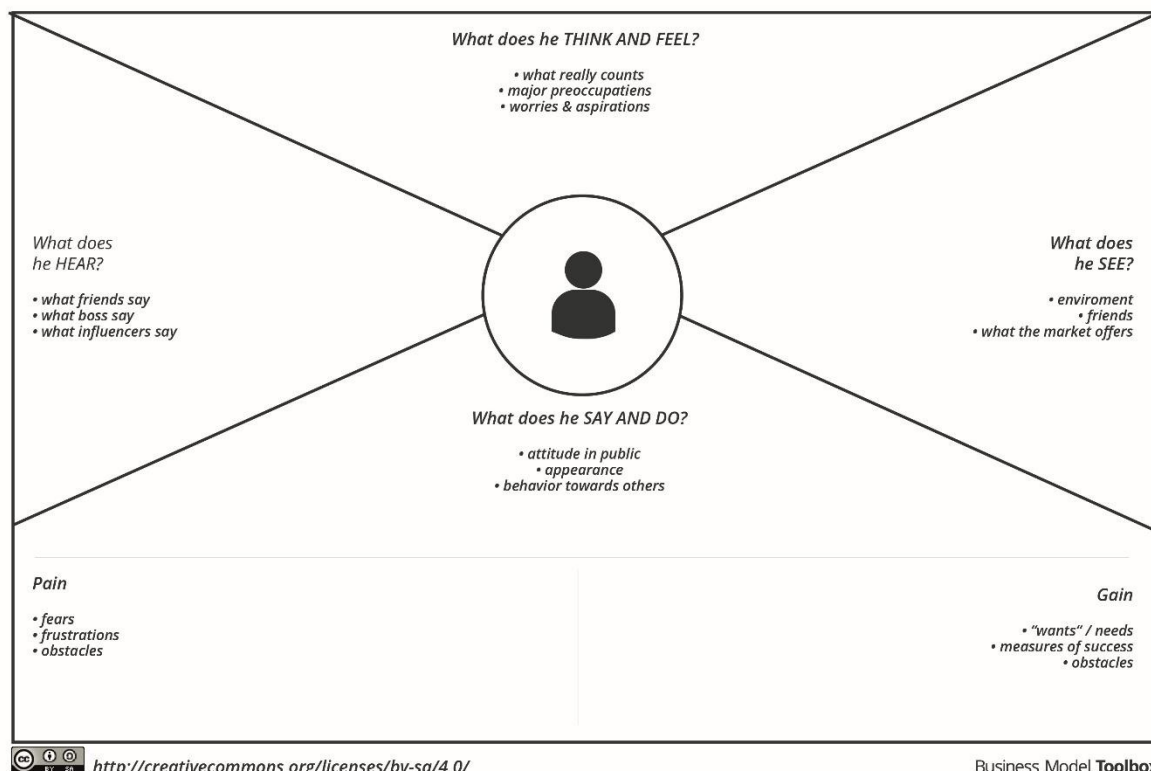
An empathy map is a simple, easy-to-digest visual that captures knowledge about a user's behaviours and attitudes.

It is a useful tool to help teams better understand their users.

Creating an effective solution requires understanding the true problem and the person who is experiencing it. The exercise of creating the map helps participants consider things from the user's perspective along with his or her goals and challenges.

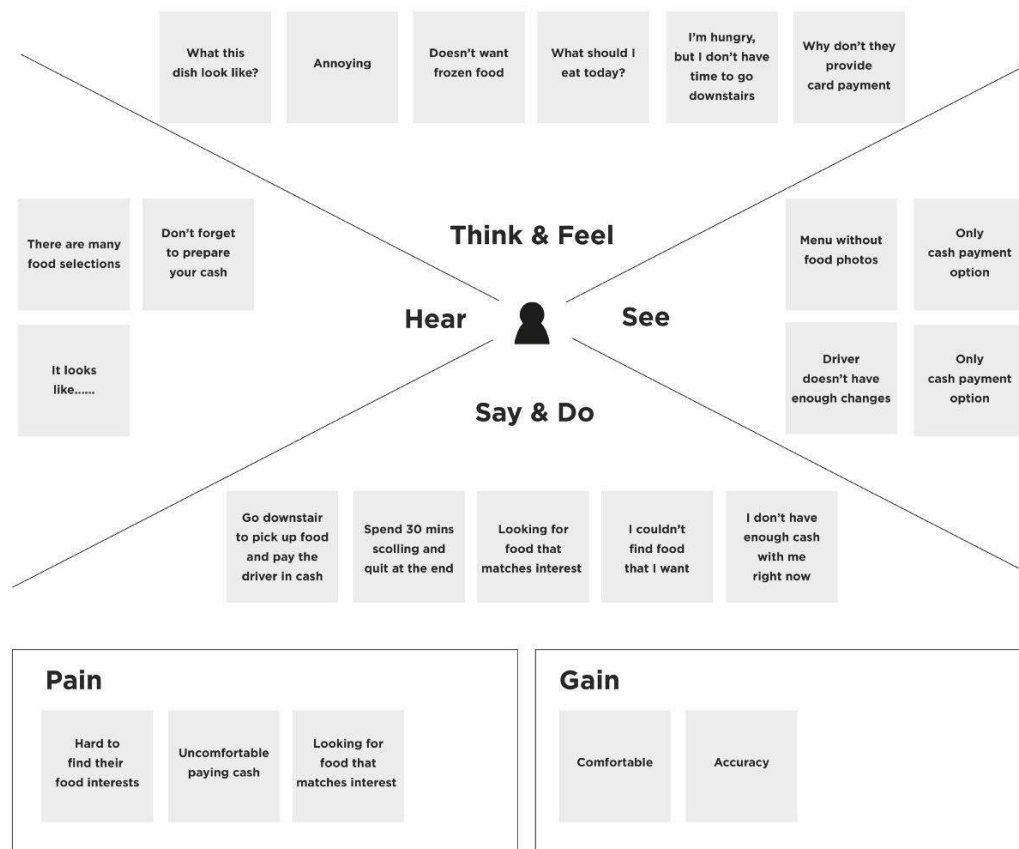
Example:

Empathy Map



Reference: <https://www.mural.co/templates/empathy-map-canvas>

Example: Food Ordering & Delivery Application



Smart Lender – Empathy Map (Loan Applicant Persona)

Persona: Ramesh, a 32-year-old self-employed applicant seeking a home loan.

THINKS & FEELS

- Worried the bank will reject the loan after a long wait.
- Wonders which factor (income, credit history, property area) hurts his chances most.
- Wants clarity before investing time in paperwork.

SEES

- Friends and family going through slow, opaque loan processes.
- Multiple lenders with different, unclear eligibility criteria.

SAYS & DOES

- Asks bank staff informally about his chances before applying.
- Compares loan offers across banks manually.
- Fills forms hesitantly, unsure which details matter most.

PAIN

- No instant feedback on eligibility.
- Time lost on applications that get rejected.

GAIN

- An instant, self-service check of approval likelihood.
- Clear visibility into the confidence level of the prediction.